

EXERTIONAL HEAT ILLNESS



DEFINITION OF EXERTIONAL HEAT ILLNESS

THE HEAT PRODUCED IN OUR BODIES FROM EXERCISE INCREASED BY THE WEATHER OR ABUNDANCE OF CLOTHING.

PREVENTION MORE EFFICIENT THAN TREATMENT

TYPES OF EXERTIONAL HEAT ILLNESS (EHI)

EXERCISE-ASSOCIATED MUSCLE CRAMPS

Visible cramping in part or all of the muscle or muscle groups, localized pain, dehydration, thirst, sweating, or fatigue

HEAT SYNCOPE

Brief episode of fainting associated with dizziness, tunnel vision, pale or sweaty skin, and a decreased pulse rate while standing in the heat or after vigorous exercise

HEAT EXHAUSTION

Excessive fatigue, faints, or collapses with minor cognitive changes, weakness, dizziness, headache, vomiting, nausea, lightheadedness, low blood pressure, and impaired muscle coordination

EXERTIONAL HEAT STROKE

CNS dysfunction and a core body temperature greater than 40.5°C (105°F).

EXERTIONAL HEAT INJURY

Moderate to severe heat illness characterized by end-organ damage. Evaluation usually reveals very dark (cola-colored) urine, severe muscle pain, and abnormal blood chemistry levels

- Heat acclimitization period of 7-14 days - this should consist of gradually increasing time, intensity and protective equipment
- Individuals who have a viral infection or are experiencing fever or a rash should not participate in activity as this increases risk of EHI (see Risk Factors)
- Maintaining proper hydration - This should start the day before and continue throughout the training session as well as post-practice.
- If practicing more than 1x per day, prioritize rest periods of 2-3 hours that include meal times and rehydration.
- Cold/ice tubs and ice towels should be available during hot and humid weather. (see Treatment)
- Wet Bulb Globe Temperature (WBGT) is the gold standard not heat index - Heat index is measured assuming shady and light wind conditions, while WBGT is measured in the sun.

RISK FACTORS FOR EHI

Ageing, dehydration, body composition, males over females (sex differences), previous infection ➔ medications that may increase risk: antihistamines, amphetamines

FOR MORE
INFORMATION,
VISIT OUR
WEBSITE BY
SCANNING THE QR
CODE BELOW!



TREATMENT FOR EHI

Cold/Ice Tub
Ice towels
Ice Packs to cheeks/palms/soles
Passive cooling (shade)
Hydration
Evaporation Cooling
Call 9-1-1 for medical care